

Pages:

Who We Are

- About us
- ANB Artists
- ANB 2027 Leadership
- Artistic Collaborators

What We Do

- Upcoming Programmes

Support ANB

- Ways To Donate
- Current Sponsors

Get In Touch

- Contact Us

About Us

Auckland New Ballet are Tāmaki Makaurau's newest and only collective of professional ballet artists.

Auckland New Ballet began as a dream - seven freelance ballet dancers who realised a shared passion for connecting audiences with ballet. We realised there was no home for classical ballet in Auckland and its surrounding regions, and with hours of donated time, trust and belief, Auckland New Ballet was born. Our goal is to introduce the awe, grace and power of ballet to new and diverse audiences, up-close and deeply immersive. We're passionate about sharing our incredible art form and believe all should have the chance to experience ballet's ability to move and inspire.

We're here to connect to, converse with, and move people.

What We Do

As a small and lightweight company we have the flexibility to showcase a diverse mix of repertoire and storytelling and bring our performances to under-served regions of New Zealand. We aim for our work to be immersive, close-up and unexpected and to foster connection and dialogue with new and returning audiences.

ANB was founded on these core principles:

- *We believe compelling art lies at the intersection of **storytelling** and **rigorous technical skill***
- *We believe in the enduring power of dance to **communicate emotion, uplift and inspire***
- *We celebrate the profound **history** and generational knowledge passed down within the language of classical ballet, and aim to evoke **authentic emotional engagement** with audiences*
- *We believe **ballet is for all** and should be accessible and welcoming **financially, intellectually**, and that audiences should leave **compelled and inspired***
- *We believe in using the choreographic language of classical ballet to tell new and contemporary stories to affirm it as a **living and relevant art** in Aotearoa New Zealand*
- *We celebrate the unique cultural fabric and **taonga tuku iho** of Aotearoa and use this to direct our aims in programming, marketing and staging in order to cement our work in the creative imprint of New Zealand dance*

We are passionate about the enduring power of ballet to transmit emotion, to uplift and to inspire. We believe ballet should be accessible and welcoming financially and intellectually, and that audiences should leave deeply moved.

ANB Artists

Madison Fotti-Knowles - ANB Founder and Artist

Madison completed her pre-professional training at the Moscow State Academy of Choreography before apprenticing with New York Dance Project and City Ballet of Boston. Until the Covid-19 Pandemic she performed with Russian National ballet. Since 2020 she has been a Freelance dancer in NZ and has guested internationally with Fever's Ballet of Lights and the Stars of Russian Ballet Gala. Her favourite dance memory is taking class in the Ulanova Studio of Bolshoi Theatre.

Amelia Chandulal-Mackay - ANB Founder and Artist

Amelia is an Auckland-based classical dancer and a 2026 Peacocke Dance Trust grant recipient. Since 2024, she has performed as an artist with Ballet Collective Aotearoa under Turid Revfiem, which remains some of her most fulfilling work to date. Her New Zealand performance credits span festivals throughout the country and include works by Loughlan Prior, Turid Revfiem, Sarah Knox and Mary-Jane O'Reilly. Internationally, Amelia has danced with Milwaukee Ballet II, Oklahoma City Ballet's studio company, and Orlando Ballet, and trained on full scholarship at the Ailey School in New York. Collaborating across the creative sector, she has also performed at NZ Fashion Week and led an international campaign for Viltrox. She is passionate about building a place for classical and contemporary ballet within the independent dance sector.

Zoe White - ANB Founder and Artist

A graduate of Rambert School (2020) and Sydney Dance Company's Pre-Professional Year (2021), Zoe has since worked in a wide range of projects, including multiple performances with the Ballet Collective Aotearoa (*The Miraculous Mandarin*, *Koolish Zein*, *FEVER/DREAM*) and Black Grace (*RAGE RAGE*, *Esplanade*). Zoe is a keen collaborator and has worked in classical and contemporary spaces, immersive theatre, music videos, short film projects, and installations to name a few. She is consistently inspired by the independent artists of Tāmaki Makaurau and this is one of the reasons she has remained in Aotearoa (along with the beautiful beaches and her amazing whānau). One of Zoe's favourite dance memories is joining the Imperial Russian Ballet's Auckland performances of *The Nutcracker* at age 9 as a child extra through the Devonport School of Dance. It felt like a dream come true, with Tchaikovsky's suite having been one of the first instigators of her love for ballet. Zoe is very excited to be on board with Auckland New Ballet as a performing artist, co-producer and choreographer for *Folklore*, and looks forward to more seasons of work to come!

Isabella Guyan - ANB Founder and Artist

Isabella trained overseas at Moorland International Ballet Academy in England, where she received her ISTD Cecchetti Diploma in Teaching. She joined B&M2 Junior Company in France dancing both neo-classical, and contemporary pieces. Isabella moved back to England to dance at Northern Ballet's Graduate Program, and toured performing the Children's' Ballet 'Tortoise and the Hare'. Since then, Isabella has been performing at SkyCity in 'Sleeping Beauty', 'Peter Pan', and 'Cinderella', and teaching at ballet schools in Auckland. One of Isabella's favourite memories of dancing is hearing the children laugh and react to her as Molly the Mole in Tortoise and the Hare. Isabella is excited to be a part of ANB, and bring more dance opportunities to Auckland audiences and dancers.

Kimberley Mear - ANB Founder and Artist

Kimberley Mear began her ballet training at Thames Hauraki Ballet Theatre before joining the Future Dancers Programme at Mount Eden Ballet Academy. She continued her studies at Melbourne City Ballet and the National Theatre Ballet School. One of her favourite training experiences was dancing in Toronto at Canada's National Ballet School while competing in the Genée International Ballet Competition. Kimberley later joined the Victorian State Ballet, touring extensively throughout regional Australia in a wide range of full-length classical ballets. After returning to New Zealand, she gained her STOTT Pilates qualifications and became a Registered Royal Academy of Dance teacher through the Professional Dancers' Postgraduate Teaching Diploma. Alongside teaching dance and pilates, she continues to perform professionally with Fever Global's *Ballet of Lights*. Kimberley is excited to be a part of Auckland New Ballet and is passionate about fostering a vibrant dance community, expanding access to live ballet, and supporting artistic opportunities through performance and education.

Louis Ramsay - ANB Founder and Artist

Louis trained at the Australian Ballet School, graduating in 2019. He joined Queensland Ballet's Young Artist program for two years. He has since returned home to Auckland to dance freelance and is studying to be a nurse. Louis has been a guest artist at several ballet school productions in Auckland and Christchurch. His favourite memory of dancing is as a child extra for Greg Horsman's *Sleeping Beauty* for the RNZB in 2011, which he then performed again 10 years later with Queensland Ballet. Louis finds ANB a space to continue to dance beloved classical repertoire.

Katrina Casey - ANB Artist

Katrina is a graduate of the New Zealand School of Dance (NZSD). During her training she seconded with the Royal New Zealand Ballet for their 2025 season of *'Dazzlehands'*, guest performed at the South Island Ballet Awards, and worked with various international choreographers. She is studying towards a Bachelor of Health Science in Physiotherapy and teaches ballet. Katrina's favourite dancing memory is performing Christopher Hampson's *'Esquisses'* staged by Turid Revfeim in the NZSD 2025 Performance Season. She is thrilled to make her professional debut with Auckland New Ballet and hopes to help grow the local arts scene through her work.

Grace Ella - ANB Founder and Production Mentor

BIO HERE

Artistic Collaborators

Zara Ridley - 2026/7 Technician in Residence

Kulios Ensemble - 2026/7 Musicians in Residence

Sponsors

M. D. Fotti

Family Office Advisory

Pure Dance

Erin Bowerman Strength and Conditioning

In 2026 Auckland New Ballet has been fortunate to receive additional funding and assistance from:

Wellesley Studios

Auckland Council

<https://www.aucklandcouncil.govt.nz/>



We would also like to express our thanks to these major 2026 Donors:

Hamish Mackay
Doug and Marianne Cooper
Kelly Knowles
Sarah Lewis
Seb Heath
Leanne Mear
Sarah-Jane Morgan
Peter Guyan

ANB 2027 Leadership:

Creative Director:

Madison Fotti-Knowles

Producer:

Zoe White

Support Producer:

Isabella Guyan

Rehearsal Director:

Meaghan Rowe

Social Media Manager:

Amelia Chandulal - Mackay

Upcoming Season

Experience a brand new season of work from Auckland's newest and only classical ballet collective!

Auckland New Ballet is proud to present their inaugural season of work, *Folklore*, a ballet performance in 2 acts.

Presented at the stunning Holy Trinity Cathedral with live accompaniment by the Kulios Ensemble, *Folklore* celebrates humanity's enduring fascination with myth, fairytale and fable.

This is ballet as you've never experienced it - up-close, immersive and intimate.

Folklore is presented in 2 acts:

Tales of the Past - A selection of exciting excerpts from the classical ballet repertoire including Giselle, Raymonda, Don Quixote, Swan Lake and more.

Songs of Tomorrow - Three brand new neoclassical works choreographed by and for members of Auckland New Ballet.

Choose from one of two Evening performances or our Quiet Matinee - a sensory-friendly, family-oriented experience with lower sound and lighting and open doors for freedom to enter and exit throughout the performance.

Each performance concludes with a Q+A with the dancers onstage for audience members to connect with our Artists about the performance - this is your chance to ask anything you've ever wanted to know about ballet!

Upcoming Performances:

September 18th 7PM

September 19th 1PM and 6PM

Holy Trinity Cathedral, Parnell

Summer Regional Tour

Auckland New Ballet are excited to bring folklore to Waiheke Island, Whanganui, Tauranga and Kerikeri this summer.

Keep an eye on our mailing list for dates and ticket info!

Support ANB

Auckland New Ballet began as a coffee shop dream - seven freelancers banding together to make art, donating time and resources to get our collective off the ground without any guarantee of pay. To see our dream of a space for professional ballet in Auckland begin to be realised has been overwhelming - we could not be more grateful for our community for banding together to support us in our September show.

We're in it for the long haul - and we want Auckland New Ballet to be around for the long haul too. We have big plans for 2027, and we're just getting started.

ANB believes passionately that ballet is for everyone and we are dedicated to connecting with as many audiences as possible. For this, we need your help:

Ways to Donate

Pointe shoe fund:

In the fairytale The 12 Dancing Princesses made famous by The Brothers Grimm, a king is driven to despair by his twelve wayward daughters and their mysterious ability to wear out a pair of dancing shoes every night by daybreak. For a professional dancer, this is more than just a fanciful story - it's a costly reality.

Pointe shoes are the most vital tool of a professional ballet dancer. In 2027, as we prepare to mount our first full season of work, the cost of purchasing pointe shoes, 'ballet flats' and boots will exceed \$7,000. Whilst within a typical full-time company structure pointe shoes, flats, character shoes and mens' boots are paid for and provided by the company, our freelance dancers must cover the costs of their shoes out of pocket. Every pair of pointe shoes is hand-made, and customised to the needs and foot shape of each dancer. The custom fit is essential for not only optimum performance and function but supporting the delicate architecture of the foot and lower leg to prevent injury. Pointe shoes typically provide about 15 hours of safe wear - this means a professional dancer may go through anywhere between 1-2 pairs a month or 1-2 pairs a week - or performance - depending on their workload, at anywhere from \$130-\$250 per pair.

EVERY RIBBON MAKES A DIFFERENCE

Our Pointe Shoe Fund is one of the most practical ways you can show your support for the dancers of ANB. Every donation, large or small, makes a world of difference to our artists - the cost of a pair of shoes, a roll of ribbon or metre of elastic, it all adds up.

- \$40 covers a pair of ballet flats
- \$90 supports a pair of men's boots
- \$135 provides a pair of custom pointe shoes
- \$675 supplies one dancer with pointe shoes for a month*
- \$2,000 supplies each dancer of ANB a pair of pointe shoes, ribbons and elastic for a Seasonal performance.

Your generosity makes every step onto stage, and in relevé in rehearsal, possible.

Sponsor us:

If you are interested in partnering with Auckland New Ballet, contact us for a sponsorship proposal.

Contact Us

Get In Touch

aucklandnewballet@gmail.com

Instagram: @aucklandnewballet

Facebook: Auckland New Ballet

Join ANB's email list here: